

Agnieszka Besz

engineering & technology leader — games & real-time systems

London, United Kingdom aga@besz.me [LinkedIn](#) [GitHub](#)

ABOUT

I've spent more than a decade building games and the teams behind them, from live mobile titles to a large open-source 3D social platform. At some point the job stopped being just engineering. I own the strategy and the budget, negotiate engine and vendor contracts, and care as much about getting the product into people's hands as about the code underneath. At Decentraland I led a ground-up rebuild of our client and grew the team from a handful of engineers into an organisation with its own managers and QA. The part I enjoy most is the people side: giving teams clarity, removing obstacles, and hiring people who are better than me. I lead with data rather than opinion, keep things simple, use AI as a normal part of how we work, and I still read the code.

WORK EXPERIENCE

VP of Engineering — Decentraland, London

2025 – Present

- Led the ground-up rebuild of the client, replacing the legacy web client with a modular, open-source desktop client that is now the platform's primary client in production.
- Set technical direction and OKRs, using telemetry to decide what we build, what we cut, and what comes first.
- Owned the technology budget and negotiated engine licensing and contracts with Unity.
- Expanded distribution to the Epic Games Store, added code-signed Windows builds, and improved launcher and onboarding reliability.
- Grew engineering from a single team of ~5 into multiple teams with engineering managers and QA leads. Built the hiring process, career ladder, and performance reviews.
- Made AI a normal part of the engineering process: AI review on every PR, AI-assisted QA, and adoption across teams. I use it daily in my own analysis.
- Shipped ~75 public builds a year, weekly or faster: terrain and LOD rendering, a major engine upgrade, a server-authoritative CRDT, hang detection with crash reporting, and automated performance tests gating every PR.

Engineering Manager — Decentraland, London

2022 – 2025

- Grew the client team from ~5 to 10+ engineers and led the rebuild that replaced the legacy web client, including the new desktop client's architecture.
- Owned the client's strategic KPIs (loading time, stability, frame rate) and the tech-debt program behind them.
- Changed how the team shipped: a predictable cadence, monitoring, and a QA bar every build had to clear.

Head of Frontend Development — Ten Square Games

2021 – 2022

- Engineering leadership for a 45+ person technology department across seven live game teams.
- Grew the department from ~25 to 45+ engineers during a major growth phase.
- Modernized lifecycle tooling and drove adoption of shared libraries across teams, so every team could iterate faster.

Technical Manager — Rovio (now Sega), Helsinki

2019 – 2021

- Led development of Angry Birds Journey from concept to soft launch and managed, mentored, and grew the programming team behind it.

Senior Game Programmer — Next Games (now Netflix), Helsinki

2017 – 2019

- Stranger Things: Puzzle Tales and The Walking Dead: No Man's Land (Android/iOS) — core game systems, new mechanics, and live-ops engineering.

Associate Lead Programmer → Programmer — Ubisoft RedLynx, Helsinki

2015 – 2017

- South Park: Phone Destroyer (real-time synchronous PvP, Android/iOS) — built core systems, multiplayer, AI, UI; led performance optimization and a team of programmers.

Earlier roles

2012 – 2015

- Turku University of Applied Sciences — Lecturer / Project Engineer; INTERMARUM — Programmer (shipped Leisure Suit Larry: Reloaded); Kiwi Flying Mad — Programmer & Co-founder of an indie studio.

EDUCATION

Doctoral studies (not completed), Computer Science — Turku & Opole Univ. of Technology (2013 – 2015)

MSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2012 – 2013)

BSc, Computer Science — Opole University of Technology (2008 – 2012); exchange year at Vaasa UAS, Finland

LEADERSHIP

- Strategy & OKRs
- Budget & cost ownership
- Vendor & partner management
- Cross-functional leadership
- Distribution / go-to-market
- Org design, hiring & performance mgmt

TECHNICAL

- Real-time multiplayer & rendering
- Performance optimization
- QA & release engineering
- Live operations
- AI in engineering workflows
- Unity / C#, architecture

TOOLS

- Unity / C#
- Git & GitHub CI/CD
- Sentry, Grafana
- Jira, Notion, Slack

LANGUAGES

- Polish (native)
- English (professional)
- Finnish (elementary)

RECOGNITION

DirectX 11 Competition

Best Pitch — Startup Journey Demo Day

3 publications (mobile AR, driving-inspection tooling, shooting-sports apps)